

Phase 3 — Facilitator Guide

Building Confidence: From Self-Doubt to First Move (180 minutes)

Status: Phase 2 architecture is frozen — sequence, activities, learning purpose, and timing are not changed here. This guide supports a competent facilitator; it is not a word-for-word script. The accompanying facilitator slide deck and Confidence Compass participant resource form part of the final workshop delivery package. Clance & Imes and Alison Wood Brooks are verified sources (Evidence Audit approved August 13, 2026). Block 2's imposter-phenomenon definition and Block 6's anxiety-reappraisal technique use the evidence-safe wording below. The claim that anxious and excited bodily states are 'nearly identical' has been permanently removed and must not be reintroduced in any form — including in slides, handouts, or a future word-for-word script. The Professional Identity prompts are used only as optional scaffolding in Block 3, exactly as approved; the GSE and STAR framework are not introduced anywhere.

No delivery problems were identified that make any block impossible to execute as designed: The two timing-pressure points flagged in Phase 1.5/Phase 2 (Block 2's concept-to-time ratio, Block 7's operational complexity) remain tight but executable — they are not being altered, only re-flagged below with the watch-outs a facilitator needs to manage them live.

Standard Operating Procedures (used by shorthand throughout — not re-explained per block)

[SOP-A] Pairing: Stable partners are the default: each participant is assigned one partner at the start of the workshop (during Block 1, folded into the norms segment — no added time), and that pairing is used across all paired activities (Blocks 2, 3, 4, 6, 8). This reduces hybrid transition time (fewer breakout rooms to build and dissolve) and gives relational continuity across the session. In-person: assigned pairs sit near each other or turn to each other when a pairing moment comes up. Online: the same 2-person breakout pair is reused each time. Hybrid: in-person pairs work locally while remote pairs are sent to their same breakout at the same moment, so both groups move in parallel. Odd numbers: if a co-facilitator is present, they join the remaining participant to form a pair (not a rotating trio); if not, the remaining participant joins one other pair to form a fixed trio for the whole session — decided once at assignment, not reshuffled.

[SOP-F] Discreet re-pairing request: Any participant may ask, at any time, to be moved to a different partner — without giving a reason. State this once, briefly, during Block 1's norms segment: *"If your pairing isn't working for you, let me know privately — a quiet word, or a private message — and I'll move you. No explanation needed."* Confirm before delivery which channel is being used (private chat/DM online; a quiet word or written note in person) — see Preparation Checklist.

[SOP-B] Breakout timing: State the duration and exact return time before opening the breakout. Give a 30-second warning before closing (verbally, or via platform broadcast if available). Close and reconvene at the stated time regardless of whether every pair has finished — protecting the schedule matters more than every pair reaching a natural stopping point.

[SOP-C] Opt-out / low-exposure language: Used every time an activity could involve disclosure: *"If you'd rather not share, that's completely fine — just let your partner know, or sit quietly together."* State it once per activity, briefly; don't re-justify it at length each time.

[SOP-D] Individual-write setup: Participants write privately — paper, notebook, or personal device. Standard framing: *"This is just for you. No one sees it unless you choose to share it."*

[SOP-E] Verified-source framing: Clance & Imes (1978) and Brooks (2014) are verified. Keep delivery brief and conservative regardless — this is a 180-minute workshop, not a research lecture. Plain phrasing such as 'psychologists call this...' or 'research on anxiety reappraisal suggests...' remains the right register for pacing, not because sources are unconfirmed. One standing rule regardless of verification status: never state or imply that anxious and excited bodily states are 'nearly identical' — see Block 6.

Decided: stable partners are now the confirmed default (see SOP-A), with the discreet re-pairing option (SOP-F) as the safeguard against a pairing that isn't working.

Block 1 — Welcome + Framing

Window: 0:00–0:15 elapsed (15 min)

Facilitator objective: Get the room settled, establish norms, deliver the two framing ideas the workshop depends on.

Time cues: 0:00–0:03 welcome/housekeeping · 0:03–0:05 arc preview · 0:05–0:08 framing beat 1 · 0:08–0:11 framing beat 2 · 0:11–0:14 norms · 0:14–0:15 transition.

Facilitator talking points:

- Welcome; confirm both rooms can see/hear before continuing (hybrid check)
- One-line arc preview: today moves from what's held you back to one real thing you do differently by the end
- Framing beat 1: confidence ≠ loud, visible, or dominant — quiet and considered responses count too
- Framing beat 2: entrepreneurial confidence means acting while still uncertain, not the absence of doubt
- Norms: individual-first, pairing always opt-outable, nothing leaves the room unless volunteered
- Assign stable partners now, as part of stating norms [SOP-A]: quick assignment (e.g., pre-set list, seat-based, or count-off), no extended explanation needed
- State the discreet re-pairing option once, briefly [SOP-F]: *"If your pairing isn't working for you, let me know privately at any time — no explanation needed — and I'll move you."*

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

"I'm going to pair you up now — this will be your partner for the paired moments across the workshop. If at any point that's not working for you, just let me know privately and I'll sort out a change — you don't need to tell me why."

Questions/prompts: None.

Transition to next block: *The thing that most often gets in the way of acting before we're certain has a name — let's name it.*

Hybrid delivery notes: Confirm audio/video parity before starting; face the camera and the room equally throughout the framing beats, since this block is entirely spoken.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: Not applicable — no production is required from anyone in this block.

Materials needed: On-screen text of the two framing lines, provided via the facilitator slide deck; reliable shared mic/camera setup.

Facilitator watch-outs: Don't let housekeeping run long — it eats directly into framing time. If tech issues arise, protect the two framing beats over housekeeping detail; they matter more. Partner assignment must be fast (pre-set list or count-off, not an open "find a partner" mingle) so it doesn't push into framing time.

Block 2 — Name the Doubt

Window: 0:15–0:45 elapsed (30 min) — Lie Detector, Option B

Facilitator objective: Participants recognize imposter syndrome as a common, nameable pattern and privately reframe it — with no disclosure required at any point.

Time cues: 0:15–0:18 transition/set expectations · 0:18–0:21 definition + Emma scenario · 0:21–0:26 facilitator-narrated story, two pauses · 0:26–0:32 individual private reflection · 0:32–0:34 myth/reality · 0:34–0:35 key takeaway · 0:35–0:37 optional one-word pair exchange [SOP-A/C] · 0:37–0:42 private reframe (write if useful; no sharing required) · 0:42–0:45 bridge.

Facilitator talking points:

- Set expectation up front: nothing in this block needs to be said aloud
- Definition: imposter syndrome — difficulty internalizing your own success: attributing your achievements to factors other than your own ability, and fearing you'll be exposed as less capable than others believe (verified). When explicitly naming the research, use 'imposter phenomenon' and 'Clance & Imes, 1978' — 'imposter syndrome' is the familiar participant-facing phrase, not the original authors' term; don't present it as if it were.
- Emma scenario, briefly: accepted to present at a conference, doubts she's earned it

- Narrate the continuing story yourself (not passed around the room); pause twice, ~5 seconds each, for silent private noticing
- Myth/reality: doubt isn't evidence of unreadiness
- Key takeaway: keep loose/unattributed unless a specific quote has been verified

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Take a few quiet minutes. You don't need to write anything unless it helps you — just notice whether anything like Emma's experience has happened to you.*
- *In a moment you'll have the option — just the option — to turn to your partner and share one word for how that noticing felt. One word only. Passing is completely fine.†*
- *After that, take a few more minutes with this: jot a note in your own notebook, paper, or device if it's useful — or just keep reflecting mentally. Nothing is collected, and nothing needs to be shared.‡*

Questions/prompts (private reflection): *Can you recall a time when lack of confidence made you reluctant to pursue a goal? What would you do differently now?*

Transition to next block: *You've just named something that's been quietly present. Now let's look at what's actually true about what you bring.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A/B] for the optional one-word pair moment — trigger the breakout quickly, keep it short (2 minutes), give a clear 30-second warning before closing.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] Declining the pair moment and continuing private reflection instead is explicitly fine — state this before pairing, not just imply it.

Materials needed: Private writing space (participant-supplied); breakout capability.

Facilitator watch-outs: This is the tightest block in the workshop — don't let the narrated story run long, and protect the private reflection window over any elaboration. Keep the optional pair moment to one word; don't let it drift into a fuller disclosure conversation.

† [SOP-C] ‡ [SOP-D]

Block 3 — Articulate Value

Window: 0:45–1:15 elapsed (30 min)

Facilitator objective: Each participant names one real strength with a specific example and tells it, in their own words, to one other person.

Time cues: 0:45–0:47 transition · 0:47–0:49 definition · 0:49–0:51 Emma scenario · 0:51–0:52 myth/reality · 0:52–0:53 key takeaway · 0:53–0:54 entrepreneurship link · 0:54–0:56 instructions + individual write · 0:56–1:02 pair share and reflect-back [SOP-A] · 1:02–1:04 Confidence Compass · 1:04–1:08 optional whole-group share · 1:08–1:12 circulate/buffer · 1:12–1:15 bridge.

Facilitator talking points:

- Definition: strength articulation — naming a skill or ability clearly, with evidence, so others understand the value
- Emma scenario: mentorship circle, hesitates to mention her design background as relevant
- Myth/reality: "only directly relevant skills count" is false — a strength becomes valuable once connected clearly to the outcome
- Key takeaway / entrepreneurship link: brief

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Write down one strength you have, and one specific moment it showed up — at work, in study, or in life.*
- *If you're stuck, try one of these: What do people regularly ask for your help with? What's one thing you do particularly well? What specific example demonstrates it? (optional scaffolding only — offer, don't require)*
- *Then tell your partner about it in your own words — you don't need to read what you wrote word for word.*
- *Partner: reflect it back — 'What I hear as your strength is ___, and I saw it in ___.'*

Questions/prompts (Confidence Compass): *Think of a strength you have that doesn't seem directly related to your venture or goal. How might it actually be an asset once you explain the connection?*

Transition to next block: *A whole strength statement is a lot to hold onto — next, we narrow it to the one line that matters most.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A] pairing; this block has more slack than Block 2, so breakout trigger/return carries lower risk.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] Participant may keep the strength private and simply confirm readiness to move on with their partner, rather than telling it aloud.

Materials needed: Private writing space; the three scaffolding prompts (wording to confirm against your Professional Identity Formation resource at script stage); breakout capability.

Facilitator watch-outs: Don't let the optional group share run long — protect the transition buffer. Some participants will default to listing job duties rather than a specific moment; the partner's "I saw it in ____" reflect-back is designed to catch this — let the mechanic do the work rather than correcting participants directly.

Block 4 — Sharpen the Message

Window: 1:15–1:35 elapsed (20 min)

Facilitator objective: Each participant tightens their value statement into one memorable sentence and confirms a partner can retain it.

Time cues: 1:15–1:17 transition · 1:17–1:19 definition · 1:19–1:20 Emma scenario · 1:20–1:21 myth/reality · 1:21–1:22 key takeaway · 1:22–1:24 individual write · 1:24–1:30 pair test [SOP-A] · 1:30–1:32 optional group share · 1:32–1:35 bridge to break.

Facilitator talking points:

- Definition: key message — the one thing you want remembered, even if everything else is forgotten
- Emma scenario: a friend recalls three different things after her rehearsal — none the intended point
- Myth/reality: covering many points doesn't mean the audience remembers what matters most; one clear message does

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Write the one sentence you most want remembered from what you just told your partner.*
- *Read it to your partner. A moment later, without looking at anything, they'll try to say it back in their own words.*

Questions/prompts (Confidence Compass): *If someone asked a listener afterward 'what was the one thing they said,' would the answer match what you intended?*

Transition to next block: *That sentence is what you'll be using shortly. Let's take a short break first.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A/B] pairing; comfortable time budget relative to Block 2.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] Participant may show the sentence in writing (chat, screen, or paper) instead of saying it aloud for the retention check.

Materials needed: Private writing space; breakout capability.

Facilitator watch-outs: Participants often want to keep more than one sentence — gently hold the line at one. Don't let the optional share eat into the break that follows.

Block 5 — Break

Window: 1:35–1:45 elapsed (10 min)

Facilitator objective: Physical/cognitive reset; protect hybrid synchrony for the return.

Time cues: 1:35–1:45, full block.

Facilitator talking points: State the exact return time clearly — spoken and displayed if possible.

Activity instructions participants need to hear: None — free time.

Questions/prompts: None.

Transition to next block: On return, reference the sharpened sentence from Block 4 before naming the feeling of being about to use it.

Hybrid delivery notes: Announce the return time identically to both rooms. If a co-host is available, have them monitor remote return.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: Not applicable.

Materials needed: [Flag] visible countdown or clearly posted return time, shared identically to both rooms.

Facilitator watch-outs: Hybrid groups often drift back at different paces — start Block 6 promptly at the stated time regardless of stragglers, to protect the downstream schedule.

Block 6 — Manage the Moment

Window: 1:45–2:00 elapsed (15 min)

Facilitator objective: Participants notice the physical sensation of pre-action nerves and practice relabeling it, immediately before acting.

Time cues: 1:45–1:46 transition · 1:46–1:48 definition + Emma scenario · 1:48–1:49 myth/reality · 1:49–1:50 key takeaway · 1:50–1:51 individual noticing · 1:51–1:53 private word-swap · 1:53–1:56 pair exchange [SOP-A/B] · 1:56–1:58 facilitator normalizing comment · 1:58–2:00 bridge to action.

Facilitator talking points:

- Definition: anxiety reframing — relabeling the physical sensation of nervousness as excitement. Evidence-safe framing (verified, Brooks 2014): research on anxiety reappraisal suggests that interpreting pre-performance arousal as excitement can support performance. The only physiological point that may be made, if any is made at all: anxiety and excitement are both high-arousal states. Do not say their bodily states are ‘nearly identical,’ and do not imply the technique removes or eliminates the nervousness — only that reframing it can help.
- Emma scenario: heart racing backstage; a mentor suggests saying "I'm excited" instead
- Reframe (deliver as a technique supported by research — verified, Brooks 2014): trying on a different word for the same sensation can change how it's experienced. Keep the framing conservative: ‘research on anxiety reappraisal suggests that interpreting pre-performance arousal as excitement can support performance’ — not that it removes the nervousness, and not that anxious and excited bodily states are the same thing.

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Notice the physical feeling you get before doing something that takes nerve, and the word you usually use for it.*
- *Try swapping that word for 'excited.' Say your usual word once to your partner; then say 'excited' instead. Notice what shifts — or doesn't.*

Questions/prompts (private reflection): *What word do you usually use for your nerves before speaking up? What might change if you swapped it for 'excited' next time?*

Transition to next block: *That feeling is exactly what you're bringing into what's next.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A/B] — this pair moment is very short (2–3 minutes); the breakout trigger and return must be fast and clearly signaled so setup time doesn't eat into an already-tight block.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] The noticing-and-swap can be done silently or in writing rather than spoken aloud to a partner.

Materials needed: None beyond the standard SOP tools already in use.

Facilitator watch-outs: Keep the research framing brief — this still should not become a mini-lecture on the underlying science; the source being verified doesn't change the pacing need. The block only works if it stays fast, stays on the reappraisal technique itself, and flows directly into the action block. Permanent rule, not a pending flag: never assert that anxious and excited bodily states are 'nearly identical.' The only supported physiological line, if used at all, is that both are high-arousal states.

Block 7 — Take the Action

Window: 2:00–2:35 elapsed (35 min)

Facilitator objective: Each participant drafts a real outreach message and either sends it or commits to a specific, dated action within seven days.

Time cues: 2:00–2:02 transition · 2:02–2:04 definition + Emma scenario · 2:04–2:05 myth/reality · 2:05–2:06 key takeaway · 2:06–2:07 entrepreneurship link · 2:07–2:09 instructions · 2:09–2:15 individual drafting · 2:15–2:21 pair test [SOP-A] · 2:21–2:23 present the two paths · 2:23–2:31 action window (send/commit) · 2:31–2:33 optional low-disclosure normalizing moment · 2:33–2:35 bridge.

Facilitator talking points:

- Definition: speculative outreach — reaching out with no advertised opening, connecting your value to something specific about the recipient, with a low-pressure ask
- Emma scenario: wants to reach a design studio, nearly deletes an over-long message
- Myth/reality: a speculative message doesn't need to justify itself at length — short, specific, and low-pressure works best

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Think of one real person or organization you could reach out to. Write two lines: one reason you're reaching out, specific to them, and one small, easy-to-say-yes-to ask.*
- *Test it with your partner — read it aloud. Their only job is to answer honestly: is the ask clear, specific, and easy to respond to?*
- *You now have two options, and neither is better than the other: send your message right now if you're ready, or write down one specific action and a date within the next seven days. No one needs to say which one they're doing, or who the message is for.*

Questions/prompts (Confidence Compass): *Think of an organization or person you've wanted to reach out to but haven't. What's the smallest possible ask you could make?*

Transition to next block: *Not every outreach lands well. Next, how to hold whatever comes back.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A/B] — the highest-complexity moment in the workshop. Use a visible, shared countdown for the 8-minute action window if available, so both rooms move through it together; don't let one room's pace pressure the other.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] Drafting silently and skipping the partner read-aloud is fine — move straight to the private send/commit decision.

Materials needed: Participants' own devices for anyone sending in the moment. The private seven-day commitment is captured directly in the Confidence Compass (Make Your Move) — no separate resource needed.

Facilitator watch-outs: This is the most operationally complex block in the workshop. Keep the two-path explanation to one clear, neutral statement — don't over-explain it. Resist checking in on who's sending versus committing. Protect the full 8-minute action window even if some participants finish early; let early finishers sit with it rather than moving them along.

Block 8 — Hold the Setback

Window: 2:35–2:50 elapsed (15 min)

Facilitator objective: Each participant builds a resilience response that keeps the door open after a setback.

Time cues: 2:35–2:36 transition · 2:36–2:38 definition + Emma scenario · 2:38–2:39 myth/reality · 2:39–2:40 key takeaway · 2:40–2:42 individual recall/write · 2:42–2:47 pair share and reflect-back [SOP-A] · 2:47–2:49 facilitator normalizing comment · 2:49–2:50 bridge.

Facilitator talking points:

- Definition: rejection resilience — taking in what a rejection actually tells you, without treating it as a verdict on your worth or capability, and without dismissing it as meaningless either
- Emma scenario: a rejection email from an accelerator; her instinct is to assume it confirms every doubt
- Core reframe (deliver close to this wording): *"A rejection is information about an outcome, not a complete verdict on your capability or worth. You can examine what it tells you without letting it define you."*

Activity instructions participants need to hear:

- *Think of a rejection you've experienced. Write down one thing that was still true about your skill or effort, regardless of that outcome.*
- *Share it with your partner. They'll reflect it back: 'So even after that, ____ was still true.'*

Questions/prompts (Confidence Compass): *Think of a rejection you're still carrying some weight from. What's one thing it didn't actually change about your ability or effort?*

Transition to next block: *Let's bring all of this together.*

Hybrid delivery notes: [SOP-A/B] — standard pairing procedure, lower time pressure than Block 7.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: [SOP-C] Reflect privately; partner simply confirms readiness to move on rather than hearing the content.

Materials needed: None beyond existing SOP tools.

Facilitator watch-outs: Keep this general, not a live debrief of Block 7 — don't ask, directly or implicitly, whether anyone's outreach from the previous block was already rejected. The reflection is about a past setback, not a real-time report. Keep the framing balanced in both directions — this isn't "rejection doesn't matter," and it isn't "rejection defines you." Over-correcting toward either extreme undercuts the point.

Block 9 — Close + Commitment

Window: 2:50–3:00 elapsed (10 min)

Facilitator objective: Consolidate the arc and close on forward motion.

Time cues: 2:50–2:51 transition · 2:51–2:56 recap of arc · 2:56–2:58 closing framing · 2:58–2:59 logistics · 2:59–3:00 close.

Facilitator talking points:

- One line per block: doubt named → value found → message sharpened → moment managed → action taken → setback held
- Closing framing: *"Success isn't only feeling more confident today. It's what that confidence helps you do next."*
- Thanks, and any follow-up information

Activity instructions participants need to hear: None — no new exercise.

Questions/prompts: None new.

Transition to next block: Not applicable — end of session.

Hybrid delivery notes: Deliver the close with equal audibility/visibility to both rooms, matching the opening.

Inclusive/low-exposure alternative: Not applicable.

Materials needed: None new; the closing recap visual is provided via the facilitator slide deck.

Facilitator watch-outs: Resist adding a closing share-out even if energy is high and participants want to talk — the approved architecture has no new exercise here. If participants want to keep talking, that's a natural cue for informal time after the session, not a scripted addition to it.

Facilitator Preparation Checklist

Technology

- Reliable shared mic/camera setup for hybrid delivery, tested before Block 1
- Video platform with 2-person breakout room capability, tested in advance on the actual platform being used
- A way to display simple on-screen text (framing lines in Block 1, closing recap in Block 9) — provided via the facilitator slide deck
- A fallback plan for pairing if breakout rooms fail (e.g., direct message pairing)

Hybrid setup

- Room layout that lets in-person participants turn easily to a neighbor
- Camera/mic positioned so remote participants see and hear the facilitator equally throughout, not just during activities
- Consider a co-facilitator or tech host to manage breakout timing while the lead facilitator holds the room — most valuable for Block 7's branching action window

Breakout/pair logistics

- Stable partners are the confirmed default across Blocks 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, assigned during Block 1 — no further decision needed here
- Confirm the channel for discreet re-pairing requests (SOP-F) before delivery: private chat/DM online, a quiet word or written note in person
- A tested breakout duration + 30-second-warning routine on the actual platform, reusing the same pair each time
- Odd participant numbers: co-facilitator pairs with the remaining participant if one is present; otherwise a fixed trio is formed at assignment and kept for the whole session — confirmed, no longer open

Participant materials

- Confirm what's provided vs. bring-your-own for private writing (paper/notebook or device)
- Confirmed final wording for the three Professional Identity scaffolding prompts in Block 3, checked against your source resource

Timing tools

- A visible/shared timer for the facilitator; ideally visible to participants too during the break (Block 5) and the branching action window (Block 7)
- A facilitator run sheet with the cumulative elapsed-time markers used above, for on-the-day pacing

Resources still needing creation

- A polished, word-for-word facilitator script — deliberately not created at this stage
- Confirmed breakout/pairing tooling for whichever platform is used on the day

Final Bibliography (APA 7th Edition)

Only the two sources that support content surviving in the workshop, with independently verified bibliographic fields (Evidence Audit, August 13, 2026).

Brooks, A. W. (2014). Get excited: Reappraising pre-performance anxiety as excitement. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 143(3), 1144–1158. <https://doi.org/10.1037/a0035325>

Clance, P. R., & Imes, S. A. (1978). The imposter phenomenon in high achieving women: Dynamics and therapeutic intervention. *Psychotherapy: Theory, Research & Practice*, 15(3), 241–247.

No DOI is included for Clance & Imes — the commonly circulated DOI for this record could not be independently confirmed against an authoritative registry and is intentionally omitted.